

ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES

Environmental Studies

Interdepartmental Undergraduate Program

Environmental Studies deals with the relationship and interactions between humans and the environment. Students in any college at ISU may elect to take a secondary major or minor in Environmental Studies. The curriculum is designed to give students an understanding of current and emerging environmental issues and an appreciation of different perspectives regarding these issues. Courses are provided for students pursuing careers related to the environment and for others who simply want to know more about environmental issues.

The secondary major in Environmental Studies requires a total of 24 credits, including 1 course from the list of general survey courses, 1 course from the list of integrative/issues courses, and 2 courses from the list of human/societal perspectives courses. At least 12 credits must be 3000 level or above. At least 6 credits must be earned at ISU. Credits used to meet the secondary major requirements may also be used to satisfy the credit requirement of graduation and to meet credit requirements in courses numbered 300 or above.

Environmental Studies is a secondary major; students must meet all university-wide requirements for the Secondary Major (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofagricultureandlifesciences/#corecurriculumtext>).

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, students should be able to:

- Demonstrate a broad understanding and appreciation for a range of environmental issues spanning natural and human systems.
- Demonstrate an understanding and appreciation of different perspectives regarding environmental issues.
- Demonstrate an understanding of approaches used in addressing environmental problems including data analysis and problem-solving.

Secondary Major

The Environmental Studies secondary major is taken in addition to a primary major and provides the breadth of preparation and integrated perspective necessary to understand environmental issues. See the university-wide requirements for an explanation of s (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>)econdary majors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofagricultureandlifesciences/#corecurriculumtext>) in the context of degree planning.

Students seeking a major in Environmental Studies complete 24 credits of ENVS coursework including:

At least one general survey course chosen from:

ENVS 1010	Environmental Geology: Earth in Crisis
ENVS 1200	Introduction to Renewable Resources
ENVS 1730	Environmental Biology
ENVS 2010	Introduction to Environmental Issues

At least one integrative/issues course chosen from:

ENVS 1600	Water Resources of the World
ENVS 2040	Biodiversity
ENVS 3240	Energy and the Environment
ENVS 3420	World Food Issues: Past and Present
ENVS 4040	Global Change
ENVS 4240	Sustainable and Environmental Horticulture Systems
ENVS 4500	Issues in Sustainable Agriculture

At least two human/societal perspectives courses chosen from:

ENVS 2700	Foundations in Natural Resource Policy and History
ENVS 2830	Introduction to Environmental Politics and Policies
ENVS 2930	Environmental Planning
ENVS 3200	Ecofeminism
ENVS 3340	Environmental Ethics
ENVS 3450	Population and Society
ENVS 3550	Literature and the Environment
ENVS 3630	U. S. Environmental History
ENVS 3800	Energy, Environmental and Resource Economics
ENVS 3820	Environmental Sociology
ENVS 4840	Sustainable Communities
ENVS 4910	Environmental Law and Planning

Beyond these three requirements, any Environmental Studies course and up to six credits of approved environmental coursework outside of Environmental Studies may be applied toward the 24-credit total for the major. Regardless of their home college, Environmental Studies majors must complete at least 9 credits in natural sciences from the LAS General Education approved course list. Unless prohibited by program or college rules, courses used to fulfill requirements of the Environmental Studies major may also be used to satisfy general education and other requirements of departments and colleges. A combined average grade of C or higher is required in courses applied to the major.

Minor

The minor in Environmental Studies requires a total of 15 credits, including 1 course from the list of general survey courses, 1 course from the list of integrative/issues courses, and 2 courses from the list of human/societal perspectives courses. At least 9 credits must be

numbered 2000 level or above, of which at least 6 credits are in courses numbered 3000 level or above. At least 3 credits must be earned at ISU. At least 3 credits must be used only in the minor, the additional 12 credits can be used to satisfy other university, college, or major requirements. A combined average grade of C or higher is required in courses applied to the minor,

Students will choose from the list of approved courses:

At least one general survey course chosen from:

ENVS 1010	Environmental Geology: Earth in Crisis
ENVS 1200	Introduction to Renewable Resources
ENVS 1730	Environmental Biology
ENVS 2010	Introduction to Environmental Issues

At least one integrative/issues course chosen from:

ENVS 1600	Water Resources of the World
ENVS 2040	Biodiversity
ENVS 3240	Energy and the Environment
ENVS 3420	World Food Issues: Past and Present
ENVS 4040	Global Change
ENVS 4240	Sustainable and Environmental Horticulture Systems
ENVS 4500	Issues in Sustainable Agriculture

At least two human/societal perspectives courses chosen from:

ENVS 2700	Foundations in Natural Resource Policy and History
ENVS 2830	Introduction to Environmental Politics and Policies
ENVS 2930	Environmental Planning
ENVS 3200	Ecofeminism
ENVS 3340	Environmental Ethics
ENVS 3450	Population and Society
ENVS 3550	Literature and the Environment
ENVS 3630	U. S. Environmental History
ENVS 3800	Energy, Environmental and Resource Economics
ENVS 3820	Environmental Sociology
ENVS 4840	Sustainable Communities
ENVS 4910	Environmental Law and Planning

Elective Environmental Studies Courses:

ENVS 1080	Introduction to Oceanography	3
ENVS 1110	Geological Disasters	1
ENVS 1300	Natural Resources and Agriculture	3
ENVS 1400	Climate and Society	3
ENVS 2200	Globalization and Sustainability	3
ENVS 2500	Environmental Geography	3

ENVS 3190	Analysis of Environmental Systems	3
ENVS 3900	Internship in Environmental Studies	1-30
ENVS 4070	Watershed Management	4
ENVS 4600	Controversies in Natural Resource Management	3
ENVS 4900	Independent Study	1-30

The Environmental Studies Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor.

In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.